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സാധാരണ ജീവിതം അസാധാരണ ശ്രദ്ധ

Monthly Newsletter

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BENCH FELLOWSHIP PROGRAM REPORT

Session 5



The Bench Fellowship is a part-time program tailored for first-year MSW students in Kerala, spanning 45 to 60 days over an 18-month period. This innovative initiative aims to unearth and nurture exceptional qualities in young individuals, empowering them to make a meaningful impact within their communities.

- Assumption College, Changanacherry
- St. Thomas College, Thavalappara
- St. Gregorios College, Parumala

PARTICIPATING COLLEGES



The 5th session of the Bench Fellowship camp took place from July 11-13, 2025, at KPMC Nallatanny. This session focused on the "Art of Creative Writing" workshop, led by M. Noushad, and was attended by 14 fellows.



DAY 1: CREATIVE WRITING

The camp commenced on the evening of July 11th, with M. Noushad introducing the fundamentals of creative writing. He discussed various types of writing, including journalistic, academic, technical, and creative writing, highlighting their distinct characteristics. The session also covered literary devices such as metaphor, irony, oxymoron, paradox, and understatement, as well as the concepts of denotative and connotative meanings.

After the introductory session, the fellows were asked to write riddles, which proved to be a fun and engaging exercise. The fellows created innovative and original riddles, showcasing their creative writing skills.



HIGHLIGHTS



The day concluded with a few minutes of silence, allowing the fellows to reflect on their experiences and prepare for the next day's activities.

DAY 2: CREATIVE WRITING

The second day of the camp began at 9:00 a.m., with M. Noushad delving into the writing process. He explained the various stages of writing, including pre-writing, research, drafting, receiving, editing, and publishing.

- Elements of Writing - essential elements of writing, such as central idea, supporting material, organization, expression, word choice, point of view, spelling, grammar, and punctuation.
- "Found Poetry" Activity - Each fellow was given a magazine and asked to read an article, cut out 30 words of their choice, and then craft a poem using those exact words.
- Guidelines for Building a Narrative - importance of being clear, structuring the narrative effectively, evoking emotions, bringing voice, deciding on style, tone, and pace.

HIGHLIGHTS



The evening was spent relaxing and taking a walk, allowing the fellows to appreciate the natural surroundings. Later, the group focused on creative structures, exploring different approaches to storytelling.

The day concluded with a few minutes of silence and gratitude, providing an opportunity for reflection and introspection before retiring for the night.

DAY 3: CREATIVE WRITING

The third and final day of the camp began at 9:00 a.m., with a focus on report writing, a crucial skill for fellows to master, especially during fieldwork. M. Noushad provided guidance on how to structure and write effective reports.

Referencing Books - Following the report writing session, M. Noushad explained how to properly reference books, emphasizing the importance of academic integrity and proper citation.



HIGHLIGHTS



CONCLUSION

Next Stage of Bench Fellowship - After lunch, Jibin briefed the fellows on the next stage of the Bench Fellowship program, which involves working with tribal communities. This preview gave the fellows a sense of what to expect and how to prepare.

Key Achievements:

The fifth session of the Bench Fellowship camp came to a close after the fellows expressed their gratitude. The camp provided a valuable opportunity for learning, growth, and bonding among the fellows, and they departed with newfound skills and knowledge to apply in their future endeavors.